Neural Microscopy Foreground Segmentation

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Purpose and intended demonstration

Train a small neural pixel classifier on synthetic microscopy scenes and evaluate on separate images. This is a computational biology learning project with synthetic or fictional inputs, not a clinical or experimentally validated system.

How the implementation works

Extract local 3x3 pixel windows and classify each center pixel using an eight-unit tanh hidden layer and logistic output. Backpropagate binary cross entropy through both layers.

Evaluation and evidence

Train and validate on entire independent images rather than randomly splitting neighboring pixels. Select the probability threshold on validation images and report test intersection over union against an intensity threshold baseline.

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Setup and commands

Requires Python 3.10 or newer and NumPy. Create a virtual environment: python -m venv .venv. On Windows use .venv\Scripts\python.exe if activation is unavailable. Install with python -m pip install -r requirements.txt. Run python app.py, then open results/report.html in your browser. Run python -m unittest discover -v to execute tests. The default seed is 42; change it with --seed. Replace sample_input.json using --input path-to-file.json, preserving its schema. Algorithm-only projects generate synthetic arrays from the seed rather than consuming external files.

Architecture and file responsibilities

CLI arguments -> JSON input or seeded generator -> domain pipeline -> validation or evaluation -> JSON and HTML artifacts. Imported functions can be used in a notebook or a separate application. Model checkpoints preserve learned arrays where applicable; see app.py for parameter order. This package does not include a production web service. Each project is independent and includes its own helper code so the ZIP can be extracted and run alone. app.py holds the experiment and domain functions: image, patches, init, forward, loss_grad, iou, run. kit.py contains reporting, input loading and only the retrieval or generation helpers needed by this project. sample_input.json contains editable inputs. test_app.py checks domain behaviors; test_reporting.py checks metrics and HTML output boundaries. results/metrics.json records outputs and results/report.html provides a browser-readable report. Numeric projects also save arrays or learned parameters to results/artifacts.npz; inspect its keys with numpy.load. MODEL_CARD.md explains intended use and limits. .github/workflows/tests.yml runs tests and the fixture experiment. No API key is needed.

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Limitations and next improvements

Synthetic circles stand in for cells. This predicts foreground pixels, not separate cell instances, and does not reproduce CellSAM or clinical pathology performance. Use licensed microscopy masks, split by specimen, compare U-Net and pretrained models, and measure instance-level segmentation errors.

Interview walkthrough

Present the problem and demonstrate one normal example, then one failure or boundary case. Explain the baseline or fixture mode, the split or validation design, and one limitation before discussing an extension. Be ready to trace data through the functions listed above. Explain why the chosen metric matches the task and why the available results cannot establish production performance. Add your own documented experiment and be precise about what you implemented or changed. These are AI-assisted educational projects; filenames and synthetic scores are not evidence of client work.

Research context and reading

These topics were selected from research directions reviewed on 22 October 2026. Recent activity suggests useful skills to develop; it is not a forecast of hiring, commercial success or scientific validity. The implementation is a small educational baseline and does not reproduce or claim the performance of any cited foundation model. Reading: CellSAM: a foundation model for cell segmentation (2025): https://www.nature.com/articles/s41592-025-02879-w.

Verified build results

project

"Neural Microscopy Foreground Segmentation"

test iou

0.908256880733945

intensity baseline iou

0.782258064516129

selected threshold

0.2

training images

10

split

"Independent whole images for training, validation and test"

See results/metrics.json for all observations and TEST_RESULTS.txt for the executed tests. All datasets and replay responses shipped here are synthetic. Results can vary across seeds and numerical library versions.